SERANOVA MED SPA | STAFF GUIDE

RF Mono: Setting the Right Expectations

Consultants set expectations first. Technicians repeat them during every treatment.

1. At Consultation

- **It's a heat-based treatment.** Redness afterward is normal and expected, and it usually fades within a few hours.
- Some clients get **mild, temporary bumps or a blotchy look** in the treated area.
- **It doesn't need to be burning hot to work.** It should feel like a **7–8 out of 10, like the sun on your skin.**
- **The client helps guide the temperature.** We can't feel the heat the way they do, so they need to tell us when to raise it, lower it, or hold it.
- If it gets too warm, they can end up with a **heat rash or irritation**, which is why speaking up matters.
- **Hair in the area can make it feel stingy**, especially in resistive mode, and can leave small scabs at the hair follicles. It's most comfortable when the area is hair-free, so ask clients to shave about 24 hours before their appointment (see section 5).
- **Beyond aesthetics:** this technology is also used by physical therapists for pain and scar tissue. Learn about the treatment so you can explain its benefits with confidence.

2. During Treatment: What to Say

> *"You're in control of the temperature. When it feels like the sun on your skin, about a 7–8 out of 10, let me know and I'll keep it there. If it ever gets too warm, tell me right away so we can avoid a heat rash."*

3. During Treatment: What to Do

- **Check in about the temperature often.** Don't wait for the client to speak up.
- **Keep looking at the skin.** Stop or lower the setting if you see bright, sharply outlined redness or any blistering, or if the client says it feels sharp or hot in one spot.
- **Write down the settings** and any reaction in the client's notes.

4. Before the Client Leaves

- **Show them the treated area** and tell them what's normal (redness, mild bumps that fade).
- Tell them to **call us right away** if anything blisters, breaks open, or becomes more painful.

5. Hair in the Treatment Area: Why It Matters

Resistive mode uses an uncovered metal electrode, so the current passes straight into the skin and the heat stays close to the surface. Hair gets in the way:

- **Hair blocks contact.** Hair conducts poorly and traps tiny pockets of air between the electrode and the skin. The current crowds into the few spots that do touch, and those spots get much hotter. That is the stinging, prickly feeling.
- **Follicles carry current into the skin.** The follicle is moist and oily, so it conducts better than the dry hair or the skin around it. Heat concentrates right at each follicle.
- **That heat can irritate or injure the follicle.** This is what causes irritated follicles or the small scabs some clients get at each hair.
- **Hair pulls.** It catches in the cream and tugs as the handpiece glides.

How to handle it

- **Before the appointment:** ask clients to shave the area about **24 hours before**, not right before. Freshly shaved skin is more sensitive.
- **If they arrive with hair:** tell them it may feel stingy and that small scabs at the follicles are possible, and let them choose whether to go ahead or reschedule.
- **If you treat over hair:** use plenty of conductive cream, keep the handpiece moving, lower the power, and check in more often.
- **If they report stinging:** lower the setting or move off the area right away. Stinging is not the same as the warm 7–8 we are aiming for.
- **Note it in the chart** if the area had hair and how the client tolerated it.

6. Abdominal Treatments

- Heating the abdomen can speed up the intestines and can bring on or worsen menstrual cramps. **Mild stomach cramping, bloating, or needing the bathroom afterward can happen.** Tell clients this at consultation so it doesn't surprise them.

Thank you for taking such good care of our clients!